

Treasury Policy

Impactstory (a North Carolina nonprofit corporation, dba OpenAlex, formerly dba Our Research; EIN 46-1599252; a 501(c)(3) public charity; fiscal year July 1 – June 30)

Adopted by the Board of Directors on: 3 September 2026

1. Purpose and scope

This policy governs how the organization holds, moves, and safeguards its funds: bank accounts, payment authorization, the treatment of restricted grant funds, and the investment of reserves. It applies to all funds of the organization and to everyone acting on its behalf. It is intentionally proportionate to the organization's size: a small staff, a simple banking structure, and controls placed where the money actually moves.

2. Roles and authority

1. **The Board of Directors** approves this policy, reviews it as needed (Section 8), approves the annual budget, and must approve by resolution any borrowing or debt on the organization's behalf (Bylaws, Art. VII §5).
2. **Authorized officers.** Only two officers are authorized to handle the organization's money: the **Chief Executive Officer** (currently Jason Priem) and the **Chief Operating Officer** (currently Kyle Demes). This authority covers opening, closing, and holding signing authority over bank accounts; initiating and approving payments and transfers; and holding organizational payment cards.
3. **Advisory role.** The **Chief Technology Officer** (currently Casey Meyer) advises on finances, in particular by translating infrastructure and server budgets into financial terms, but does not execute payments, transfers, or banking actions.
4. No other staff member, contractor, or agent may move the organization's funds. Changes to the set of authorized officers require Board approval.

3. Bank accounts

1. The organization holds its funds in accounts at FDIC-insured United States banking institutions (currently Wells Fargo), consisting of: a main operating account, one or more

dedicated grant treasury accounts (Section 5), organizational credit card accounts, and a savings account.

2. A current register of accounts is maintained by the Chief Operating Officer in the organization's internal finance documentation. Account numbers and access credentials are never recorded in this policy or in other shared documents.
3. Opening or closing a bank account requires the agreement of both authorized officers and is reported to the Board at its next meeting.

4. Payments and dual control

1. Routine payments are made by organizational credit card where accepted, and otherwise by ACH or wire through the organization's payment platform or the bank. An authorized officer initiates each payment.
2. **Dual-control threshold.** Any single payment or transfer over **\$25,000** requires the documented approval (email or equivalent written record) of the *second* authorized officer before it is initiated, unless the payment is part of the agreed payment schedule of a commercial contract that has already been approved.
3. Transfers out of a grant treasury account are always dual-controlled regardless of amount (Section 5.3).
4. Payments are recorded in the organization's books by its bookkeeping provider and reviewed in the monthly close.

5. Restricted grant funds

1. Grant funds subject to funder restrictions are **restricted funds**. They are tracked and reported as such in the organization's accounts, and spending against them follows the approved grant budget and the funder's conditions.
2. Where a funder requires it (as the Wellcome Trust does for grant 323416/Z/24/Z), grant receipts are held in a **dedicated treasury account**, separate from the operating account, used only to receive and hold that grant's funds.
3. Funds leave a grant treasury account only to reimburse the operating account for approved grant expenditure: both authorized officers jointly review the supporting financials and initiate the transfer, and, where the funder's process requires it, only after the funder has approved the expenses to be recovered.
4. **Only grant funds enter a grant treasury account.** Payments received from a funder that are not grant funds (for example, a membership or service invoice paid by the same organization) are deposited to the operating account and recorded as earned revenue, not as grant income.

6. Investment of reserves

1. The organization does not speculate with its funds. Funds not needed for near-term operations may be held only in: insured bank deposits (including savings and

money-market deposit accounts), U.S. Treasury securities, or money-market funds invested in U.S. government obligations.

2. Equities, cryptocurrencies, derivatives, foreign-exchange positions, and any other speculative instruments are not permitted.
3. The organization maintains a designated operating reserve of **\$500,000**, held in its savings account, separate from day-to-day operating funds. The organization intends to grow this reserve to \$1,500,000 (approximately three months of operating expenses), funding the increase from one-off revenue as it is received. The authorized officers may adjust the reserve amount within the budget the Board has approved; changes are reported to the Board at its next meeting. Restricted grant funds (Section 5) are not part of this reserve.

7. Borrowing

The organization may not borrow money, issue debt, or pledge its assets without a resolution of the Board of Directors (Bylaws, Art. VII §5).

8. Approval and review

1. This policy takes effect upon approval by the Board of Directors.
2. The Board reviews this policy as needed, for example when banking arrangements, officers, or funder requirements change. Any officer or director may bring the policy to the Board for review; the policy remains in force until amended by the Board.
3. Exceptions to this policy require prior Board approval and are recorded in the Board's meeting record.